FUNCTIONAL EVIDENCE-BASED ASSESSMENT TASKS

Evidence First.
Scores Second.

An evidence-based assessment platform.

Built for any context where performance matters more than accuracy.

FEAT

WHERE IT STARTED

Where it started

FEAT began as a writing assessment. Not a traditional one.

Most writing tests measure the language you use. Grammar. Vocabulary. Punctuation. Whether you can produce the right kind of text in the right kind of format.

FEAT was built on a different question. Not *can you write correctly* — but *can you communicate effectively*. Can you inform, argue, explain, justify?

That shift was intentional. Vocational education has always assessed this way. Competent or not yet competent. FEAT was built on that same foundation.

Define the function. Set the criteria. Collect the evidence.

THE PROBLEM

The problem with how we assess

Most assessments measure proxies. Format. Accuracy. Recall. The right answer in the right box.

Consider the extremes. A candidate with poor accuracy who communicates clearly. A candidate with perfect accuracy who communicates nothing useful. On a traditional test, they often look the same.

We know jagged profiles exist. An assessment that collapses everything into a single score will always struggle to show you which one you are dealing with.

Most assessments ask: can they recall it, select the right answer, or produce the right format?	**FEAT asks: can they perform the function?**

HOW IT WORKS

You define what competence looks like.

FEAT goes and finds the evidence.

01

Define the function

A learning objective. A job requirement. An academic skill. Whatever performance looks like in your context.

02

Set the criteria

What does competent look like? What does not yet competent look like? Your subject matter experts set the threshold.

03

Collect the evidence

The AI examiner prompts, follows up, challenges, and probes until a confidence threshold is reached. Competent or not yet competent.

No multiple choice. No essays. No single right answer. Structured evidence, collected through dialogue, measured against criteria you define.

Language analysis is available where it adds insight. It does not drive the outcome unless you want it to.

WHAT YOU GET

Not a score. A profile.

+ Which functions are demonstrated.
+ Which are not yet evidenced.
+ Where the gaps are.
+ Reported against the criteria you set — defensible, specific, and actionable.

Before and after. Cohort and individual. Point in time or across a programme. Confirmed or not confirmed. Nothing in between.

Learning checks / Progress testing

USE

Checking whether learners can apply what they have been taught. Not just recall it.

WHY

Most progress tests measure memory. A learner can score well and still be unable to use what they know in context. If the objective is application, the assessment should test application. This works across any subject — not just language learning.

WHAT THE SYSTEM NEEDS

The functions tied to each stage of the course. Performance criteria defining what competent application looks like. These map directly to existing learning objectives.

WHAT THE SYSTEM DOES

The AI examiner tests each function through structured dialogue until a confidence threshold is reached. Each function is marked competent or not yet competent.

WHAT YOU GET

Not a grade. A functional profile. A clear picture of where each learner is against course objectives — and what to teach next.

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE

HOW IT FLOWS

01
Define
Learning objectives as functions

→

02
Set
Competent / not yet criteria per objective

→

03
Examine
AI probes application, not recall

→

04
Profile
Competent or not — per objective

Confidence threshold reached at each stage — Competent / Not yet competent

Vocational testing

USE

Testing whether candidates can perform the functions that matter in a specific role — defined by the people who know that role best.

WHY

FEAT cannot test whether someone can fix a car or operate equipment. But it can establish whether they know what to do, why, and in what order — more effectively than multiple choice, because it follows up and probes reasoning.

WHAT THE SYSTEM NEEDS

Subject matter experts define the functions relevant to the role and set the performance criteria. What does competent look like in this context? That definition drives everything.

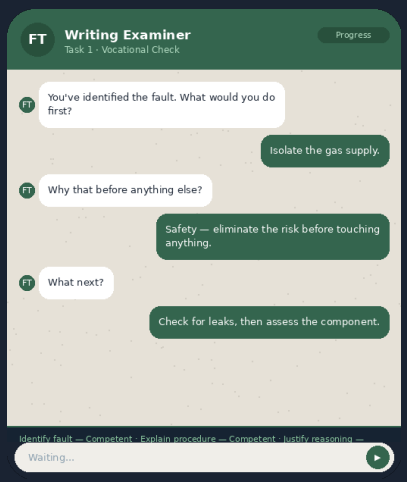
WHAT THE SYSTEM DOES

The AI examiner simulates the communicative demands of the role. It collects evidence against each criterion until confidence thresholds are reached.

WHAT YOU GET

A role-specific competence profile. Defensible, contextually grounded, and tied directly to the criteria your experts defined.

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE



HOW IT FLOWS

01
Define
Role functions with subject matter experts

→

02
Set
Performance criteria per function

→

03
Examine
AI probes reasoning and process knowledge

→

04
Profile
Role-specific competence map

Confidence threshold reached at each stage — Competent / Not yet competent

Candidate screening

USE

Identifying the candidates most likely to succeed before they reach the final stage.

WHY

CVs tell you what candidates claim. A short test tells you very little about performance. What distinguishes strong candidates is usually functional — how they reason, respond under pressure, and handle ambiguity.

WHAT THE SYSTEM NEEDS

A definition of the functions that distinguish strong candidates from weak ones. Set by hiring managers or talent leads. Performance criteria for each function.

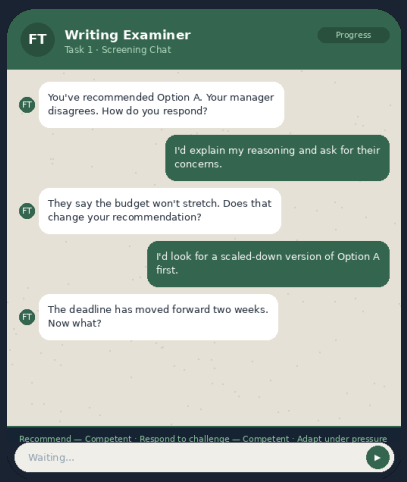
WHAT THE SYSTEM DOES

The AI examiner puts each candidate through the same structured evidence collection process. It probes and challenges until confidence thresholds are reached.

WHAT YOU GET

A ranked, evidence-based candidate profile. Consistent across every candidate. Defensible if challenged. Built on performance, not presentation.

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE



HOW IT FLOWS

01
Define
Functions that distinguish strong candidates

→

02
Set
Threshold criteria per function

→

03
Examine
Same process — every candidate

→

04
Profile
Ranked evidence-based shortlist

Confidence threshold reached at each stage — Competent / Not yet competent

Academic skills assessment

USE

Assessing whether students have the academic skills needed to succeed. Not whether they can write a well-structured essay.

WHY

Most academic assessments conflate academic ability with writing ability. A student who analyses and evaluates well may score poorly if their expression is weak. A student who writes fluently but thinks superficially can pass undetected.

WHAT THE SYSTEM NEEDS

A defined set of academic functions — analyse, synthesise, evaluate, justify, compare. Performance criteria that distinguish competent from not yet competent. Set by the institution or subject matter expert.

WHAT THE SYSTEM DOES

The AI examiner tasks the candidate with performing each function, probes for depth, and collects evidence until it reaches a confidence threshold.

WHAT YOU GET

A profile of academic function. Which skills are demonstrated. Which are not yet evidenced. Defensible, criteria-referenced, specific to what your programme requires.

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE

HOW IT FLOWS

01
Define
Academic functions: analyse, evaluate, argue

→

02
Set
Competence criteria by level

→

03
Examine
AI probes depth of thinking

→

04
Profile
Academic function map

Confidence threshold reached at each stage — Competent / Not yet competent

21st century skills

USE

Assessing critical thinking, communication, argumentation, and problem framing. The skills that matter most and are hardest to measure.

WHY

21st century skills appear on every curriculum framework and almost no assessment. Hard to test with multiple choice. Hard to mark with essays. So they get talked about and not measured. That gap is costly.

WHAT THE SYSTEM NEEDS

A definition of the skills that matter in your context and what competent performance looks like for each. These can map to existing frameworks or be defined from scratch.

WHAT THE SYSTEM DOES

The AI examiner creates the conditions for each skill to be demonstrated, collects evidence through structured dialogue, and reaches a confidence threshold.

WHAT YOU GET

Evidence that these skills are present or not. Collected consistently. Measured against defined criteria. Reported as a profile, not a single score.

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE

HOW IT FLOWS

01
Define
Skills that matter in context

→

02
Set
What competent performance looks like

→

03
Examine
AI creates conditions for each skill

→

04
Profile
Skills present / not yet evidenced

Confidence threshold reached at each stage — Competent / Not yet competent

CPD and workforce development

USE

Establishing what your people can do before training. And whether that has changed after it.

WHY

Most CPD is measured by attendance and completion. Neither tells you whether anything shifted. Organisations invest in training without knowing whether it worked — and without baseline evidence to measure against.

WHAT THE SYSTEM NEEDS

The functions your training is designed to develop. Performance criteria agreed by L&D; leads or line managers. The same criteria used before and after the programme.

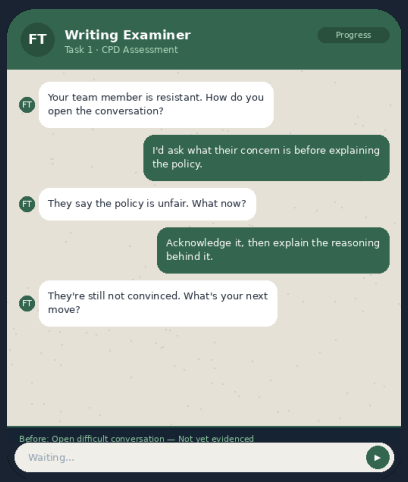
WHAT THE SYSTEM DOES

The AI examiner collects evidence of each function before training begins and again at the end. Same process. Same criteria. Comparable evidence.

WHAT YOU GET

A before and after profile. Where gaps existed. Where they closed. Where they did not. Evidence that your investment did or did not move the needle.

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE



HOW IT FLOWS

01
Baseline
Collect evidence before training

→

02
Train
Programme runs as normal

→

03
Re-assess
Same criteria — same process

→

04
Compare
Before and after profile

Confidence threshold reached at each stage — Competent / Not yet competent

Placement testing

USE

Knowing what learners can actually do before teaching starts. Not just what level they scored at.

WHY

A placement score tells you where to put someone. It does not tell you what they can do when they get there. Two learners at the same level can have very different functional profiles. Teaching them the same thing is a poor use of everyone's time.

WHAT THE SYSTEM NEEDS

The functions relevant to the programme or pathway. Performance criteria for each level or stage.

WHAT THE SYSTEM DOES

The AI examiner collects evidence of functional performance across the relevant range, reaching confidence thresholds for each function before moving on.

WHAT YOU GET

Not just a level. A map of what the learner can and cannot do. Actionable from day one.

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE

HOW IT FLOWS

01 **Define** — Functions for each level or stage

→

02 **Set** — Criteria per function

→

03 **Examine** — AI ranges across levels

→

04 **Place** — Functional map — not just a score

Confidence threshold reached at each stage — Competent / Not yet competent

Diagnostic assessment

USE

Mapping where the gaps are. Before a course, mid-programme, or at any point where a clearer picture is needed.

WHY

A score tells you how someone performed overall. It does not tell you where to intervene. A diagnostic built on recall misses the learner who cannot apply what they know — or the one who reasons well but cannot organise for a reader.

WHAT THE SYSTEM NEEDS

The functions you want to diagnose. Performance criteria defining what presence or absence of each function looks like. Broad or highly specific, depending on the purpose.

WHAT THE SYSTEM DOES

The AI examiner works through each function systematically. It collects evidence and reaches a confidence threshold before marking each one present or not yet evidenced.

WHAT YOU GET

A diagnostic map. Not a score. A profile of functional strengths and gaps, specific enough to inform teaching, curriculum design, or intervention.

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE

HOW IT FLOWS

01 **Define**
Functions to diagnose

→

02 **Set**
Present / not yet evidenced criteria

→

03 **Examine**
Systematic function by function

→

04 **Map**
Strengths and gaps — actionable

Confidence threshold reached at each stage — Competent / Not yet competent

Most assessments ask:

can they recall it, select the right answer, or produce the right format?

FEAT asks:

can you perform the function?

Most assessments give you a score. A number. A pass or fail.

FEAT gives you evidence. Confirmed or not confirmed. Against criteria you defined.

The difference matters. For learners who deserve a fairer picture. For institutions that need defensible data. For employers who need to know what their people can actually do.

Function first. Evidence always.

FEAT

Functional Evidence-based Assessment Tasks.

The name says what it does.